# View fourteen varied suburbs before deciding

**Start viewing with fourteen suburbs, not one.** Three options are offered below (A balanced, B nature-first, C coast-led). Each spans the Dandenong hills, the north-east, the bay, Macedon or Geelong, and Gippsland, plus two control suburbs (Croydon and Berwick) that show what the family gives up for convenience, plus **two Community comparators** (diverse suburbs with Indian groceries, temples and churches close by) so the nature-versus-community trade-off is seen in person. Fifty-one suburbs in the research notes pass the family's hard filters (price up to $1.5M, Glen Waverley drive up to 90 min, ED drive up to 90 min); only **15 of them meet Mum's own 25-minute Glen Waverley and 20-minute ED answers**, and **11 are beyond the preferred 60 minutes**. The provisional weighted score (built from the workbook's current weights) puts **Frankston, Berwick, Ferntree Gully, Seaford and Upper Ferntree Gully** on top, because the weights favour distance, price, trains and services. The greenest places (Sassafras, Warburton, Warrandyte, Macedon) sit lower, so the viewing list is deliberately *not* the top 12 by score. The biggest open issue is the weights themselves: the workbook cut Nature to 9% although **all three family members rated Nature "Essential"**, using a shift typed in from earlier answers. Round 2 (Q13 and Q15) should settle that. **The workbook is canonical; nothing here replaces it.** Every figure below is labelled CHECKED, ESTIMATE or DATA-DERIVED.

*Read-date 27 Oct 2026; comparator update 28 Oct 2026. Workbook = "Our Next Home — Family Relocation Scoring Model.xlsx". Print the master table in landscape.*

| **Update, 28 Oct 2026: what changed since the 27 Oct version** |
|---|
| 1. **Six Community comparators added** (workbook SuburbScorecard rows 67–72, display-only, not ranked): Springvale, Clayton South, Keysborough, Clyde North ("Diverse / lower-green"); Endeavour Hills, Wheelers Hill ("Potential both"; Wheelers Hill community-lighter). All meet the price cap, the 90-min Glen Waverley limit at 08:00 and the public 24-hour ED rule on checked evidence. New section below. |
| 2. **Point Cook is conditional** (family decision on distance: 45–70 min off-peak, up to 1 hr 40 at 08:00, which fails the 90-min cap at peak). **Tarneit is excluded** (up to 1 hr 50 at 08:00). **Mount Waverley is excluded** (median over the $1.5M cap). None of the three is in the workbook. |
| 3. **Nature-first anchors** for the comparison are Frankston, Mordialloc and Seaford (the workbook's top 3 after the C3 re-scoring); **Rowville** is the reference point only. |
| 4. **Proposed viewing rule** (family to confirm): at least 2 Community comparators, at least 1 nature-first suburb, at least 1 verified "Potential both" suburb. Each option below now meets it. |
| 5. **Not yet redone (open work C7):** the scores, ranks and weights in this report are still the 27 Oct provisional calculation. The workbook now has its own entered scores (top 3 after C3: Frankston 7.00, Mordialloc 6.90, Seaford 6.89), which differ from the figures here. Use the workbook for any rank. |

| Label | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **CHECKED** | A researcher read it in a named source this session (link given). |
| **ESTIMATE** | A researcher's judgement or recall. Not verified. All Nature, Village, Beach, Shops and Indian-community scores are estimates. |
| **DATA-DERIVED** | Calculated here from a workbook number (drive minutes, train Y/N, price) with a stated formula. |

## One-page summary: three shortlists that share a core

All three options contain the same six anchors: **Eltham** (green village, rail), **Frankston South** (creek bush plus bay), **Warragul** (Gippsland, cheapest), the two controls **Croydon** and **Berwick**, and the comparator **Endeavour Hills** (bush reserve plus Indian grocer, temple and church within about 15 min). They differ in how much weight they give to forest, to the bay and to being close to family. The comparator picks per option are a proposal (judgement), chosen from the six approved.

| Type | A. Balanced (start here) | B. Nature-first | C. Coast-led |
|---|---|---|---|
| Dandenong foothills / ridge | Upwey, Belgrave, Upper Ferntree Gully | Belgrave, Sassafras, The Basin, Mount Evelyn | Upwey |
| North-east green | Eltham, Diamond Creek | Eltham, Warrandyte, Hurstbridge | Eltham |
| Peninsula / bayside coast | Frankston South, Mornington | Frankston South | Seaford, Frankston South, Mornington, Mount Martha, Dromana |
| Macedon / Geelong | Woodend, Highton | Woodend | Highton, Torquay |

| Type | A. Balanced (start here) | B. Nature-first | C. Coast-led |
|---|---|---|---|
| Gippsland | Warragul | Warragul | Warragul |
| Controls | Croydon, Berwick | Croydon, Berwick | Croydon, Berwick |
| Community comparators (new) | Endeavour Hills, Springvale | Endeavour Hills, Wheelers Hill | Endeavour Hills, Keysborough |
| Glen Waverley drive (min), original 12 | 16 to 74; 9 of 12 have a train | 17 to 68; 7 of 12 have a train | 17 to 88; 6 of 12 have a train |
| Comparators: Glen Waverley at 08:00, top of range (CHECKED) | 35 and 35 | 35 and 12 | 35 and 30 |
| Avg Nature score, original 12 (ESTIMATE; comparators unscored) | 7.2 | 8.0 | 6.7 |
| Suburbs with Beach 8+ | 2 | 1 | 6 |
| Suburbs flagged high bushfire (F-H) | 6 | 8 | 3 |
| Best for | Testing every idea once with the shortest drives | Honouring "Priority 1: green and hilly"; both comparators keep real nature (Churchill NP, Jells Park) | Mum's and Y's bay-greenery answers (Q13c); Keysborough sits between Glen Waverley and the bay |
| Gives up | Few beach days; two long drives (Woodend 68, Highton 74) | Highest fire and insurance exposure; no "Diverse / lower-green" comparator, so the strongest community contrast is not seen | Least forest; Torquay is 88 min, near the hard limit. Point Cook (coast plus diversity) would fit here only if the family accepts its distance |

**How to choose.** If the family can only do one round of viewings, take A. If Round 2 confirms Nature as Essential for everyone, switch to B. If Mum's and Y's bay answers carry the day (Q13c: Mum "coastal or bay town with greenery", Y the same, Dad "inland forest, hills"), switch to C. Each option holds 14 suburbs (12 plus 2 comparators); the union is 25 (cards below: 21 original, plus the comparators in their own section). The nature-first requirement of the viewing rule is met by the green suburbs already in each option; if the family reads it strictly as "one of Frankston, Mordialloc or Seaford", add Seaford to A and B (it is already in C). Mount Eliza is the obvious Peninsula add-on but is **over the cap** (see below) and so is not on any list.

| Four things to know before reading on |
|---|
| 1. **Prices are mostly AVMs.** 38 of 51 workbook prices are automated estimates, not sale medians (7 are sale medians, 5 are 3-bed medians, 1 is a 5-sale median). |
| 2. **Hazard overlays are unchecked for every suburb.** Only council-wide lists and news items were read; none at property level. |
| 3. **Indian groceries and temples are unverified** for the 51 scored suburbs. They are **checked for the six Community comparators** (current Google listings and drive times, 28 Oct). |
| 4. **Four suburbs were left out of the ranking as over the cap:** Blackburn ($1.60M sale median), Glen Waverley ($1.7635M, baseline only), Williamstown ($1.64M AVM; sale medians $1.49M to $1.58M) and Mount Eliza ($1.61M AVM; Jellis Craig median $1.72M). The workbook marks all four "needs data". Eight more fail the 90-minute Glen Waverley limit (Ocean Grove 92, Clifton Springs 95, Inverloch 96, Trentham 97, Curlewis 104, Ballarat 111, Castlemaine 114, Bendigo 140). |

## Community comparators: the other side of the trade-off (added 28 Oct 2026)

**Why they are here.** The 51 scored suburbs are almost all Low on community: after C3, only Berwick in the workbook's top 15 has an India-born share of 4% or more. The comparators let the family see what "Indian shops and community in your own suburb, less green" (Q13 option A) looks like before Round 2 weights are final. They are **not ranked and not meant to win**: Nature, Beach and Village carry about 44% of the weight. No overall winner is declared.

**Community band (display-only, family to confirm; workbook column AX).** High: other language at home 50% or more, or India-born 8% or more. Medium: 30–49%, or India-born 4–7.9%. Low: everything else. These ABS 2021 shares describe who lives in a suburb; they do not measure belonging or community quality. The band is not used by any score or weight.

**Basis.** All figures CHECKED unless marked. Drives: Google Maps "Depart at" Wed 28 Oct 2026, typical-traffic range, suburb centre to destination; the **top of the range** is tested against the 90-min cap. ED: public hospital (Victorian Department of Health list) and open 24 hours (healthdirect, Mercy Health). Price: "Median price, house" from a Victorian Statement of Information (SOI). Places: current Google Business listings with hours, phone or reviews. The 08:00 basis is stricter than the 27 Oct "leave now" midday figures used for the 51, so the two are not directly comparable.

| Suburb | Corner | Band (India-born / other language) | House price (SOI median) | Glen Waverley 08:00 (10:00) | Public 24-hour ED | Indian grocery | Hindu temple | Church | Nature |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Springvale | Diverse / lower-green | High (7.4% / 76%) | $942,500 (Jul 2025–Jun 2026) | 10–35 (10–26) | Monash Medical Centre Clayton 10–18 | India Town, 11b/310 Springvale Rd, 4 | Sankat Mochan Hanuman Mandir, Oakleigh South, 10–20 | St Joseph's Catholic, 4 | None of size |
| Clayton South | Diverse / lower-green | High (14.9% / 67%) | $985,000 (Apr 2025–Mar 2026) | 16–40 (14–35) | Monash Medical Centre Clayton 8–12 | Little India Mart, 2/1310 Centre Rd, 4–6; Sarawan Spices, Clayton, 5–8 | Sankat Mochan, 7–12 | St Andrew's Catholic, 76 Springs Rd, 5 | Golf courses, landfill; no reserve named |
| Keysborough | Diverse / lower-green | High (6.6% / 61%) | $975,000 (Jul 2025–Jun 2026) | 18–30 (18–24) | Dandenong Hospital 12–18 | India at Home, Parkmore SC, 4–6 | Shri Shiva Vishnu, Carrum Downs, 14–20 (gurdwara in suburb) | Church of the Resurrection, 5–6 | Market gardens to the south; no reserve named |
| Clyde North | Diverse / lower-green | High (18.2% / 54%) | $752,932 (Jun 2025–May 2026) | 35–70 (28–50) | Casey Hospital, Berwick 12–24 | Wirsa Indian Groceries, Selandra Blvd, 2 | Shrinathji Haveli, Hallam, 16–30 (BAPS, Smiths Ln, 8–12 ESTIMATE) | St Thomas the Apostle, 5 Fiorelli Blvd, 4 | Farmland; regional park only proposed |
| Endeavour Hills | Potential both | High (4.6% / 51%) | $857,000 (Aug 2025–Aug 2026) | 18–35 (16–26) | Dandenong Hospital 7–12 | India At Home, Dandenong Plaza, 8–12 | Shrinathji Haveli, Hallam, 8–14 | St Paul Apostle Catholic, 2 | James Alexander Reserve (Casuarina Forest) 1.1 km / 3 min; Churchill NP 8–10; Lysterfield Park 12 |
| Wheelers Hill | Potential both (community lighter) | Medium (4.1% / 46%) | $1,475,000 (Jun 2025–Jun 2026), 1.7% under cap | 4–12 (7–12) | Dandenong Hospital 12–18 | The Heritage Spices, 580 Ferntree Gully Rd, 6–9 | Shree Swaminarayan, Boronia, 10–20 | St Justin's Catholic, 4 | Jells Park (~127 ha) 2.6 km / 6 min |
| *Point Cook (conditional)* | Potential both | High (14.9% / 51%) | $832,750 (Feb–Apr 2026) | 55–100, **fails at peak** (45–70) | Werribee Mercy 10–16 | GROCERZ, Wallace Ave, 6–10 | Wyndham Hare Krishna, same complex (ESTIMATE ~6–10) | FaithLife, 4 | Point Cook Coastal Park 3 min; Cheetham Wetlands ~420 ha |
| *Tarneit (excluded)* | Diverse / lower-green | High (28.8% / 64%) | $677,018 (Feb–Apr 2026) | 60–110, **fails at peak** (50–80) | Werribee Mercy 14–24 | Yes Yes Indian Supermarket, 4–7 | Sri Durga, Rockbank, 16–20 | Lutheran, Tarneit Rd, 4–7 (site may have moved) | Basalt plains |

Drive figures are minutes. Anchors for comparison (workbook): Frankston (India-born 1.1%, other language 12.1%), Mordialloc (1.4% / 18.7%) and Seaford (0.6% / 9.6%), all **Low**. Reference: Rowville (3.2% / 32%, Medium); Churchill National Park edge; drives and ED not checked.

**Under-cap evidence (not the median alone).** SOI ranges or comparable sales under $1.5M are CHECKED for Springvale ($720k–$790k), Clayton South ($1.00–1.08M), Keysborough ($1.05–1.155M), Clyde North ($790–860k) and Endeavour Hills ($760–820k). Wheelers Hill: Jellis Craig sold results to 6 Sep 2026 show 3–4 bed houses sold at $1.12M–$1.225M (e.g. 8 Bottlebrush Ct, 4-bed, $1,215,000, 27 Aug 2026; report median $1.46M) (Jellis Craig). Whether a *suitable* house (single level or adaptable, enough bedrooms) exists under the cap is **not yet checked for any comparator**; that is a listings-stage job.

**One line each (trade-off).**

- **Springvale:** the most diverse (76% other language), grocer and church in walking range, 10–35 min to family; little nature.
- **Clayton South:** high India-born share and the closest major ED (8–12 min); a sand-belt suburb with little nature.
- **Keysborough:** grocer, church and gurdwara local, the large Shiva Vishnu temple 14–20 min; on the side towards the bay; little bush.
- **Clyde North:** cheapest, grocer 2 min; new estates, and the furthest of the six (up to 70 min at 08:00, over a 60-min preference).
- **Endeavour Hills:** the best "both" option: bush reserve walkable from central streets, national park 10 min, grocer, temple and church within about 15 min, ED 7–12.
- **Wheelers Hill:** next to family (4–12 min) and a 127 ha park; dearest, and only Medium on community.
- **Point Cook:** the only coast-plus-diversity option; whether 45–70 min off-peak to Glen Waverley is acceptable is a family decision. Exclude it if the 60-min preference becomes a working limit.

**Still to verify.** Endeavour Spices (Endeavour Hills) is not on Google Maps, so India At Home in Dandenong is used instead. Shri Sanatan Dharam Society (Hallam North Rd) has no opening hours listed, and its registered address is Narre Warren North, so the 4–6 min drive is an ESTIMATE. Train access for the comparators is from recall (Springvale and Clayton South yes; the other four no). Hazard overlays are unchecked, as for every suburb. Full evidence and links: `Community comparators — research (28 Oct 2026).md`.

## Master comparison: 51 suburbs that pass, grouped by region

**Key.** Rg = region (DAN Dandenong foothills and ridge, YV Yarra Valley, NE north-east and inner-east, BAY bayside and south-east, PEN Mornington Peninsula, WST west coast, MAC Macedon Ranges, GEE Geelong and Surf Coast, GIP Gippsland). Opt = in shortlist option A, B or C. Price = workbook house price plus basis: **S** sale median, **A** AVM (automated estimate, not a sale), **3B** 3-bed house median (Domain), **S5** median of only 5 sales. † = an independent source disagrees by 8% or more, or on a different basis (see disagreements). ‡ = identical AVM for Ferntree Gully and Upper Ferntree Gully (duplicate). GW = drive minutes to Glen Waverley; ED = drive minutes to the 24-hour ED the workbook used; **!** = that ED is the nearest, not a major ED (Rosebud); **?** = researchers flagged the figure. Train = station in or beside suburb (workbook, from recall; Y includes slow V/Line services). Nat, Vil, Bch, Shp, Ind = Nature, Village, Beach, Shops and doctor, Indian community, 0 to 10, all **ESTIMATE**. Score = provisional weighted score using final weights, **ESTIMATE + DATA-DERIVED**. Hazard: F fire, W flood, C coast, I industry or noise; H, M, L = researcher's rough level; * = a checked source names the hazard. All hazard levels are unverified at property level.

| Suburb | Rg | Opt | House price & basis | GW min | ED min | Train | Nat (E) | Vil (E) | Bch (E) | Shp (E) | Ind (E) | Score (rank) | Hazard |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **DANDENONG FOOTHILLS AND RIDGE** | DAN | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Upper Ferntree Gully | DAN | A | $872k A ‡ | 16 | 2 | Y | 9 | 6 | 1 | 7 | 4 | 7.64 (#5) | F-H* |
| Ferntree Gully | DAN | – | $872k A ‡ | 14 | 8 | Y | 6 | 7 | 1 | 10 | 6 | 7.95 (#3) | F-M |
| Upwey | DAN | AC | $930k S | 17 | 4 | Y | 8 | 8 | 1 | 8 | 3 | 7.58 (#8) | F-H* |
| Tecoma | DAN | – | $894k A | 19 | 5 | Y | 9 | 5 | 1 | 6 | 3 | 7.22 (#16) | F-H* |
| Belgrave | DAN | AB | $856k A | 21 | 7 | Y | 9 | 9 | 1 | 7 | 3 | 7.52 (#11) | F-H* |
| The Basin | DAN | B | $845k A | 17 | 10 | N | 9 | 7 | 1 | 4 | 5 | 6.48 (#24) | F-H |
| Montrose | DAN | – | $968k A | 22 | 12 | N | 7 | 6 | 1 | 6 | 3 | 6.01 (#28) | F-H* |
| Mount Evelyn | DAN | B | $915k A | 27 | 17 | N | 8 | 6 | 1 | 6 | 2 | 5.82 (#32) | F-H* |
| Olinda | DAN | – | $1.02M A | 33 | 15 | N | 9 | 7 | 0 | 4 | 1 | 5.34 (#40) | F-H |
| Sassafras | DAN | B | $1.01M A | 29 | 11 | N | 10 | 8 | 0 | 3 | 1 | 5.54 (#36) | F-H |
| Mount Dandenong | DAN | – | $982k A | 30 | 19 | N | 9 | 5 | 0 | 4 | 1 | 5.29 (#42) | F-H |
| Emerald | DAN | – | $981k A | 35 | 22 | N | 9 | 8 | 0 | 7 | 1 | 5.65 (#33) | F-H |
| **YARRA VALLEY** | YV | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Warburton | YV | – | $718k 3B | 65 | 53? | N | 10 | 8 | 0 | 6 | 1 | 4.53 (#48) | F-H, W-M |

| Suburb | Rg | Opt | House price & basis | GW min | ED min | Train | Nat (E) | Vil (E) | Bch (E) | Shp (E) | Ind (E) | Score (rank) | Hazard |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Healesville | YV | – | $838k A | 43 | 33? | N | 8 | 8 | 0 | 9 | 2 | 5.63 (#34) | F-H, W-M |
| Yarra Glen | YV | – | $936k A | 44 | 30? | N | 6 | 7 | 0 | 6 | 1 | 4.86 (#46) | F-M, W-M |
| **NORTH-EAST AND INNER-EAST** | NE | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Ringwood | NE | – | $1.04M S | 12 | 5 | Y | 4 | 5 | 1 | 10 | 6 | 7.58 (#7) | W-L |
| Croydon | NE | ABC | $899k A | 18 | 6 | Y | 5 | 7 | 1 | 9 | 5 | 7.54 (#9) | F-L |
| Heidelberg | NE | – | $1.45M S | 25 | 4 | Y | 6 | 6 | 1 | 10 | 6 | 7.36 (#14) | W-M |
| Rosanna | NE | – | $1.24M A | 34 | 8 | Y | 6 | 5 | 1 | 9 | 5 | 6.88 (#19) | W-M |
| Eltham | NE | ABC | $1.27M S | 26 | 16 | Y | 9 | 8 | 1 | 9 | 3 | 7.25 (#15) | F-H, W-M |
| Diamond Creek | NE | A | $885k 3B | 33 | 19 | Y | 8 | 6 | 1 | 8 | 2 | 6.77 (#20) | F-H*, W-M* |
| Warrandyte | NE | B | $1.35M A | 20 | 14 | N | 10 | 8 | 1 | 5 | 2 | 6.04 (#27) | F-H*, W-M* |
| Hurstbridge | NE | B | $981k A | 41 | 29 | Y | 8 | 8 | 1 | 5 | 1 | 6.05 (#26) | F-H, W-M |
| **BAYSIDE AND SOUTH-EAST** | BAY | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Mentone | BAY | – | $1.497M S † | 25 | 16 | Y | 5 | 6 | 9 | 9 | 5 | 7.60 (#6) | C-M |
| Mordialloc | BAY | – | $1.40M A | 28 | 14 | Y | 5 | 7 | 9 | 9 | 4 | 7.53 (#10) | W-M, C-M |
| Chelsea | BAY | – | $1.16M A | 30 | 19 | Y | 5 | 6 | 10 | 9 | 3 | 7.45 (#12) | C-M, W-M |
| Seaford | BAY | C | $861k A | 24 | 8 | Y | 7 | 5 | 9 | 8 | 3 | 7.81 (#4) | W-M |
| Frankston | BAY | – | $834k S | 25 | 4 | Y | 6 | 6 | 9 | 10 | 4 | 8.14 (#1) | C-M, W-M |
| Frankston South | BAY | ABC | $1.20M A | 31 | 4? | N | 8 | 5 | 8 | 7 | 3 | 6.49 (#23) | F-M |
| Berwick | BAY | ABC | $936k A | 25 | 6 | Y | 6 | 8 | 0 | 10 | 9 | 7.98 (#2) | F-M |
| **MORNINGTON PENINSULA** | PEN | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Mornington | PEN | AC | $1.10M A † | 40 | 15 | N | 5 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 3 | 6.50 (#22) | C-M |
| Mount Martha | PEN | C | $1.34M A | 47 | 19 | N | 7 | 6 | 9 | 8 | 2 | 5.87 (#30) | C-M |
| Arthurs Seat | PEN | – | $1.43M S5 | 52 | 13! | N | 10 | 1 | 8 | 5 | 1 | 5.18 (#43) | F-H* |
| Dromana | PEN | C | $906k A | 47 | 11! | N | 7 | 5 | 9 | 8 | 1 | 5.98 (#29) | F-H, C-M |
| McCrae | PEN | – | $959k A | 49 | 6! | N | 6 | 4 | 9 | 6 | 1 | 5.56 (#35) | C-M, F-M |
| Rosebud | PEN | – | $754k A | 49 | 3! | N | 4 | 6 | 10 | 10 | 2 | 6.29 (#25) | C-M |
| Rye | PEN | – | $918k A | 61 | 9! | N | 6 | 6 | 9 | 7 | 1 | 5.43 (#38) | C-M, W-M |
| **WEST COAST** | WST | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Altona | WST | – | $1.16M A † | 35 | 15 | Y | 5 | 6 | 9 | 9 | 4 | 7.38 (#13) | C-M, I-M |
| Newport | WST | – | $1.15M A | 35 | 14 | Y | 4 | 6 | 8 | 9 | 4 | 7.20 (#17) | W-M, I-M |
| West Footscray | WST | – | $1.05M A | 39 | 6 | Y | 3 | 5 | 4 | 9 | 6 | 6.94 (#18) | I-M, W-L |
| **MACEDON RANGES** | MAC | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Kyneton | MAC | – | $810k 3B | 77 | 47 | Y | 7 | 9 | 0 | 8 | 1 | 4.92 (#45) | F-M*, W-L |
| Woodend | MAC | AB | $890k 3B † | 68 | 55 | Y | 8 | 8 | 0 | 7 | 1 | 5.10 (#44) | F-H |

| Suburb | Rg | Opt | House price & basis | GW min | ED min | Train | Nat (E) | Vil (E) | Bch (E) | Shp (E) | Ind (E) | Score (rank) | Hazard |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Macedon | MAC | – | $1.15M A † | 62 | 60 | Y | 9 | 5 | 0 | 2 | 1 | 4.52 (#50) | F-H* |
| Gisborne | MAC | – | $1.04M A | 67 | 34 | Y | 5 | 6 | 0 | 9 | 3 | 5.33 (#41) | F-M, W-M |
| Riddells Creek | MAC | – | $994k A | 71 | 38 | Y | 6 | 7 | 0 | 6 | 1 | 4.72 (#47) | F-M |
| **GEELONG AND SURF COAST** | GEE | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Newtown (Geelong) | GEE | – | $1.18M A † | 72 | 7 | N | 7 | 6 | 4 | 9 | 7 | 5.44 (#37) | W-M |
| Highton (Geelong) | GEE | AC | $958k A † | 74 | 9 | N | 6 | 7 | 4 | 9 | 7 | 5.41 (#39) | F-M, W-M |
| Torquay | GEE | C | $1.18M S † | 88 | 23 | N | 6 | 7 | 10 | 9 | 2 | 4.52 (#49) | F-M, W-M |
| **GIPPSLAND** | GIP | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Warragul | GIP | ABC | $620k 3B | 58 | 2? | Y | 6 | 8 | 1 | 10 | 2 | 6.51 (#21) | F-M, W-M |
| Drouin | GIP | – | $702k A | 57 | 9 | Y | 5 | 6 | 1 | 8 | 1 | 5.86 (#31) | F-M, W-M |
| Wonthaggi | GIP | – | $588k A † | 88 | 3 | N | 5 | 5 | 7 | 9 | 1 | 4.40 (#51) | C-M, F-M |

The six Community comparators are not in this table: they are display-only and unscored (see the section above). Scores within 0.05 of each other are ties in practice (Ringwood and Upwey are both 7.58). Sources for the workbook columns are the workbook itself (drive times: Google Maps "leave now", not peak hour; prices: OnTheHouse/Cotality, Domain and similar, mostly 30 Sep 2026). Sources for the five estimate columns are the cards and region notes below.

## Provisional scores: how they work and why they do not replace the workbook

**Formula.** Score = sum of (criterion score × weight), on a 0 to 10 scale, using the nine criteria with data. The workbook's "easy city trip" criterion has no data in any note, so it is **excluded and the other nine weights are rescaled to 100%**. Adding a proxy (the average of the Glen Waverley and train scores) keeps 9 of the top 10 the same (Belgrave replaces Mordialloc), so the choice does not change the story.

| Criterion | How the 0 to 10 score is made | Label |
|---|---|---|
| Near family in Glen Waverley | 10 up to 15 min; falls to 5.0 at 60 min (the family's preferred limit); falls to 0 at 90 min (hard limit) | DATA-DERIVED |
| Hospital | 10 × (1 − ED minutes ÷ 90). This is the workbook's own formula in column O | DATA-DERIVED |
| Train | Yes = 10, No = 0. Yes/No comes from recall, not timetables | DATA-DERIVED |
| Price vs cap | 10 at $600k or less; falls to 5.0 at the $1.5M cap (the blueprint's "5 = at the ceiling") | DATA-DERIVED |
| Nature, Village, Beach, Shops and doctor, Indian community | Researcher's 0 to 10 rating | ESTIMATE |

**Weights used.** "Final" are the workbook's current weights after the forced-choice shifts. "Original" are the survey weights before any shift. "Rule" is my recalculation using the workbook's documented transfer rule (see disagreements). Arrow shows the weight after dropping city trip and rescaling.

| Criterion | Final weight % | Original % | Rule-recomputed % | Score type |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Near family in Glen Waverley | 23.4 → 25.5 | 16.2 → 17.7 | 17.2 → 18.8 | DATA-DERIVED |
| Nature | 9.0 → 9.8 | 16.2 → 17.7 | 15.2 → 16.6 | ESTIMATE |
| Hospital (ED drive) | 8.1 → 8.8 | 8.1 → 8.8 | 8.1 → 8.8 | DATA-DERIVED |
| Indian community | 10.7 → 11.7 | 10.7 → 11.7 | 10.7 → 11.7 | ESTIMATE |
| Shops and doctor | 10.7 → 11.7 | 8.1 → 8.8 | 9.1 → 9.9 | ESTIMATE |
| Village character | 5.5 → 6.0 | 8.1 → 8.8 | 7.1 → 7.7 | ESTIMATE |

| Criterion | Final weight % | Original % | Rule-recomputed % | Score type |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Train | 8.1 → 8.8 | 8.1 → 8.8 | 8.1 → 8.8 | DATA-DERIVED (Y/N from recall) |
| Price vs cap | 8.1 → 8.8 | 8.1 → 8.8 | 8.1 → 8.8 | DATA-DERIVED (AVMs mostly) |
| Beach | 8.1 → 8.8 | 8.1 → 8.8 | 8.1 → 8.8 | ESTIMATE |
| Easy city trip | 8.1 → excluded | 8.1 → excluded | 8.1 → excluded | no data |

**Worked example (Upwey, final weights).** Glen Waverley 9.8 × 25.5% + Nature 8 × 9.8% + Hospital 9.6 × 8.8% + Indian 3 × 11.7% + Shops 8 × 11.7% + Village 8 × 6.0% + Train 10 × 8.8% + Price 8.2 × 8.8% + Beach 1 × 8.8% = **7.58**.

**Sensitivity: top 10 under three weight sets.**

| Rank | Final weights (workbook today) | Original survey weights | Workbook's own rule, recomputed |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Frankston 8.14 | Frankston 7.80 | Frankston 7.88 |
| 2 | Berwick 7.98 | Berwick 7.70 | Berwick 7.75 |
| 3 | Ferntree Gully 7.95 | Seaford 7.56 | Ferntree Gully 7.63 |
| 4 | Seaford 7.81 | Ferntree Gully 7.55 | Seaford 7.62 |
| 5 | Upper Ferntree Gully 7.64 | Belgrave 7.55 | Upper Ferntree Gully 7.56 |
| 6 | Mentone 7.60 | Upper Ferntree Gully 7.54 | Belgrave 7.53 |
| 7 | Ringwood 7.58 | Upwey 7.44 | Upwey 7.46 |
| 8 | Upwey 7.58 | Eltham 7.24 | Mentone 7.28 |
| 9 | Croydon 7.54 | Mentone 7.21 | Eltham 7.25 |
| 10 | Mordialloc 7.53 | Mordialloc 7.19 | Mordialloc 7.25 |

Five suburbs (Frankston, Berwick, Ferntree Gully, Seaford, Upper Ferntree Gully) are in the top six under every set. Moving from the original to the final weights pulls **Ringwood (16th to 7th) and Croydon (12th to 9th) in**, and pushes **Belgrave (5th to 11th) and Eltham (8th to 15th) out**: the Nature cut hurts exactly the suburbs the family says it wants most. Raising Nature to 30% puts Belgrave first and Upper Ferntree Gully second, with Eltham 7th and Tecoma 8th. Dropping the Indian-community weight to zero moves Berwick from 2nd to 11th. A what-if on the Peninsula ED times (Dromana 40, Rye 45, McCrae 40, Rosebud 27, Arthurs Seat 37 min, **ESTIMATE** except Rosebud, which is the workbook's own Frankston figure) moves those suburbs down 0 to 6 places and changes nothing in the top 10. A price what-if for Highton at the $781,500 median instead of the $957,797 AVM adds about 0.09 points. A Healesville ED time of 50 instead of 33 minutes costs about 0.17 points.

**Why the list is logistics-led.** Five of the nine scored criteria (Glen Waverley, hospital, train, price, shops) reward convenience, and Glen Waverley alone carries 25.5%. The stated Priority 1 (forest, hills, creeks) carries 9.8% after the shift. Top-10 suburbs have Nature scores of only 4 to 9. That is why the shortlists above pull in lower-ranked, greener suburbs on purpose.

**Researcher limits.** Seven researchers scored with one rubric but no cross-calibration (for example, inland Beach is 0 in some notes and 1 in others). Each score is one person's judgement from thin sources. Treat gaps under about 0.5 points as noise.

## Profile cards: the 21 original suburbs in the three options

The six comparators are summarised in their own section above. Each card separates **Checked** facts (with links) from **Estimate**. Workbook figures are tagged as such. Header shows region, options, price and basis, Glen Waverley minutes (GW), ED minutes, train, score and rank. "Not found" means the notes did not have it.

### Option A suburbs

**Upwey** · DAN · A, C · $929,500 (S, 104 sales) · GW 17 · ED 4 · train Y · 7.58 (#8) **Checked:** Domain's 2026 page lists a 3-bed house at $860k and a 4-bed at $1.07m, in line with the workbook (Domain). Main Street sits beside the station with small shops, health services, cafes and the Burrinja Cultural Centre; Birdsland Reserve and the Ringwood–Belgrave Rail Trail are in the township (Wikipedia). Named in the Oct 2017 bushfire overlay update (Star Mail). **Estimate:** Nature 8, Village 8, Shops 8, Indian 3. Supermarket and pharmacy not confirmed; hilly streets and many split-level homes; nearest temple (The Basin) about 15 min. **Trade-off:** the best village-plus-train-plus-closeness mix in the hills; costs are the fire overlay and a thin Indian community.

**Belgrave** · DAN · A, B · $856,437 (A) · GW 21 · ED 7 · train Y (terminus) · 7.52 (#11) **Checked:** Belgrave Lake Park, Borthwick Park, Dandenong Ranges National Park, Monbulk Creek and Puffing Billy; main street with galleries and bookshops behind the station (Wikipedia). 78.8% Australia-born, India below 0.7% (not in the top five) (ABS); 99.2% separate houses (gdp.com.au); on the 2017 bushfire overlay list. **Estimate:** Nature 9, Village 9, Shops 7 (supermarket and GP 5 to 10 min, unverified), Indian 3; steep in parts; 55 to 65 min by train to the city. **Trade-off:** the strongest forest village on rail within 21 minutes of family; weekend tourist crowds, fire exposure, AVM-only price.

**Upper Ferntree Gully** · DAN · A · $872,133 (A, duplicate) · GW 16 · ED 2 · train Y · 7.64 (#5) **Checked:** adjoins Dandenong Ranges National Park, with the Kokoda Trail memorial walk and the "1000 steps"; own station since 1889 (Wikipedia). About 3,400 people, 96.1% separate houses, India-born 1.0% (34 people), median age 41 (ABS). On the 2017 bushfire overlay list. **Estimate:** Nature 9, Village 6, Shops 7 (supermarkets in Ferntree Gully 5 to 8 min), Indian 4; steep on the park side; single-level homes scarce on slopes. **Trade-off:** forest at the door, 16 minutes to Glen Waverley; the price may be a postcode-level AVM shared with Ferntree Gully.

**Eltham** · NE · A, B, C · $1,273,000 (S, 195 sales) · GW 26 · ED 16 · train Y · 7.25 (#15) **Checked:** Alistair Knox Park, Barak Bushlands, Laughing Waters, the Diamond Creek Trail and Maroondah Aqueduct Trail; Main Road strip, Sunday farmers' market, station and SmartBus 902 (Wikipedia). 79.0% Australia-born, India below 0.7%, 85.9% separate houses (ABS). **Estimate:** Nature 9, Village 8, Shops 9, Indian 3. Bushfire overlay likely over much of northern and eastern Eltham; many split-level mud-brick homes; Indian shops and temples 15 to 25 min away. **Trade-off:** the best all-round green village in the inner north-east; costs are stairs, fire and insurance, and weak Indian access.

**Diamond Creek** · NE · A · $885,000 (3B; 4-bed $1.24M) · GW 33 · ED 19 · train Y · 6.77 (#20) **Checked:** the Diamond Creek Trail follows the creek and was extended to Hurstbridge in 2022; shopping centre on the creek bank; Hurstbridge-line station; repeated bushfires 1894 to 1969 and a floodplain are recorded (Wikipedia). 83.2% Australia-born, India 0.7% (87 people), 94.3% separate houses (ABS). **Estimate:** Nature 8, Village 6, Shops 8, Indian 2; Hindu and Sikh sites 25+ min; Austin Hospital about 25 min. **Trade-off:** a cheaper green option with rail; the price is a 3-bed median, so a 4-bed is around $1.24M.

**Frankston South** · BAY · A, B, C · $1,195,044 (A) · GW 31 · ED 4? · train N · 6.49 (#23) **Checked:** Sweetwater Creek Upper Nature Reserve is a 5.3 ha bushland strip (Frankston Council); Frankston's Peninsula University Hospital runs a 24-hour ED (Peninsula Health). India-born 0.9% (169 people), median age 44 (ABS). **Estimate:** Nature 8, Village 5 (small strips only), Beach 8, Shops 7; hilly; the 4-minute ED time looks optimistic (guess 8 to 12); many older single-level homes. **Trade-off:** the only candidate offering creek bush and the bay together; no station and no village centre.

**Mornington** · PEN · A, C · $1,096,505 (A); Jellis Craig house median $1.20m · GW 40 · ED 15 · train N · 6.50 (#22) **Checked:** Jellis Craig puts the house median at $1.20m (1 Aug 2026), 9% above the workbook AVM (Jellis Craig). Buses 781, 784 and 785 together give a 20-minute service to Frankston (Transport Victoria). Population 25,759; 74.0% Australia-born; India not in the top six; 77.0% separate houses (ABS). **Estimate:** Nature 5, Village 8 (Main Street is a real centre), Beach 9, Shops 10; Frankston ED about 20 min; foreshore flooding in low pockets. **Trade-off:** the best bay-town services; busier, less forest, no train.

**Woodend** · MAC · A, B · $890,000 (3B) · GW 68 · ED 55 · train Y · 5.10 (#44) **Checked:** population 6,732, 79.5% Australia-born, India not listed (so 0.7% or less) (ABS). Jellis Craig shows an all-house median of $1.04M (to 1 Jun 2026), well above the workbook's 3-bed $890k (Jellis Craig). **Estimate:** Nature 8 (ranges forest a short drive away), Village 8 (walkable High Street), Shops 7, Indian 1; nearest 24-hour ED is Sunshine (about 70 km) or Bendigo (about 75 km); bushfire overlay over substantial areas; cold winters. **Trade-off:** forest-country village on the Bendigo line; 68 minutes to Glen Waverley is over the 60-minute preference.

**Highton (Geelong)** · GEE · A, C · $957,797 (A) · GW 74 · ED 9 · train N · 5.41 (#39) **Checked:** population 20,736; India-born 2.4%, 77.3% Australia-born (ABS). PRD's Q2 2026 house median is $781,500 on 241 sales, about $175k below the workbook AVM (PRD). A Sri Sai Siva Vishnu Temple association is listed in the Geelong directory; address not retrieved (City of Greater Geelong). **Estimate:** Nature 6 (Barrabool Hills, Barwon River), Village 7, Shops 9, Indian 7; University Hospital Geelong about 10 min; steep pockets; no local train. **Trade-off:** hills plus a real Indian community and strong services, but 74 minutes from family.

**Warragul** · GIP · A, B, C · $620,000 (3B; 4-bed $732.5k) · GW 58 · ED 2? · train Y · 6.51 (#21) **Checked:** population 19,856; India-born 1.0%; 81.0% Australia-born; median age 40 (ABS). House median $680,000 on 549 sales (Microburbs). V/Line to Southern Cross takes about 1 h 40 min, at least hourly (page dated Oct 2023) (Monash Rural Health). **Estimate:** Nature 6 (rolling hills, forest 20 to 30 min away), Village 8, Shops 10, Indian 2; nearest Indian groceries 45 to 60 min; West Gippsland Hospital ED 24-hour status and waits not read directly. **Trade-off:** by far the cheapest credible option with a town centre; low Indian community and a long train.

**Croydon (control)** · NE · A, B, C · $898,896 (A) · GW 18 · ED 6 · train Y · 7.54 (#9) **Checked:** 71.1% Australia-born, India 2.3% (665 people), 83.4% separate houses (ABS). Main Street, Croydon Central and Arndale; the station is under 5 min from Main Street, and Wikipedia noted a closure from March 2024 for level-crossing works (Wikipedia). **Estimate:**

Nature 5; foothills 10 to 15 min away; Maroondah Hospital about 10 min; Indian shops 15 to 25 min; station likely reopened, verify. **Role:** shows the cheapest "village plus train" option with modest nature; if the family prefers it, nature is not their real priority.

**Berwick (control)** · BAY · A, B, C · $935,845 (A) · GW 25 · ED 6 · train Y · 7.98 (#2) **Checked:** India-born 6.1%, Hinduism 5.5%, 62.3% Australia-born (ABS). Wilson Botanic Park: 39 ha, two former quarry lakes, boardwalk and lookout tower (Wikipedia). **Estimate:** Nature 6 (parks, not forest), Village 8 (historic village, hilltop feel), Indian 9, Shops 10; Casey Hospital ED (workbook; 24-hour status from recall); fringe fire overlay; busy Princes Highway. **Role:** the control for Q13, showing what a strong Indian community and services feel like with little forest and no beach.

## Added by Option B (nature-first)

**Sassafras** · DAN · B · $1,006,318 (A; thin sales) · GW 29 · ED 11 · train N · 5.54 (#36) **Checked:** village on a saddle of the ridge at about 500 m; much of the western locality is in Dandenong Ranges National Park; the 15 km Tourist Track follows Sassafras Creek; fire history to 1962 (Wikipedia). Population 970; 76.8% Australia-born; 354 dwellings, 98.6% separate (ABS); Belgrave (6 km) has the everyday shops. **Estimate:** Nature 10, Village 8 (tourist-led), Shops 3; overlay likely over most of the locality; narrow roads; winter ice and tree fall. **Trade-off:** the best forest in the set; no everyday shops in the village, and thin, hard-to-price sales.

**The Basin** · DAN · B · $845,187 (A) · GW 17 · ED 10 · train N · 6.48 (#24) **Checked:** Basin Triangle shops (two pubs, cafes, greengrocer, butcher, post office, gym) beside Dandenong Ranges National Park and Doongalla Forest; no supermarket or pharmacy listed; bus 755 to Bayswater, Boronia and Ferntree Gully stations (Wikipedia). The Sri Vakrathunda Vinayagar Hindu temple is in the suburb (Sukkar release). India below 0.8% (ABS). **Estimate:** Nature 9, Village 7, Shops 4 (supermarkets 8 to 12 min), Indian 5; steep roads. It is in Knox, not Yarra Ranges, so absence from the 2017 list is not evidence. **Trade-off:** forest plus a temple 17 minutes from family; car-dependent.

**Mount Evelyn** · DAN · B · $915,472 (A) · GW 27 · ED 17 · train N · 5.82 (#32) **Checked:** Aqueduct Walk, the Lilydale–Warburton Rail Trail, and parts of the national park to the south; rail closed in 1965 (Wikipedia). Population 9,799; 85.6% Australia-born; India below 0.4%; 97.8% separate (ABS); on the 2017 overlay list. **Estimate:** Nature 8, Village 6, Shops 6 (not verified), Indian 2. **Trade-off:** flat rail-trail walking and forest; the lowest Indian-community score of the east, no train, 27 minutes to family (Mum's limit is 25).

**Warrandyte** · NE · B · $1,348,901 (A) · GW 20 · ED 14 · train N · 6.04 (#27) **Checked:** Warrandyte State Park, the Yarra gorge, Andersons Creek and Mullum Mullum Creek; Yarra Street centre; fires in 1939, 1962 and 2014 (Wikipedia). Manningham applied a new bushfire overlay to about 600 Wonga Park properties in 2023 (Manningham Council); VICSES lists Warrandyte among flood-risk locations (VICSES). 77.4% Australia-born, 98.4% separate (ABS). **Estimate:** Nature 10, Village 8, Shops 5; steep driveways; the AVM probably understates large-block homes. **Trade-off:** top nature 20 minutes from family; the highest fire and insurance exposure in the north-east, and no train (direct city bus 906).

**Hurstbridge** · NE · B · $980,767 (A) · GW 41 · ED 29 · train Y (terminus) · 6.05 (#26) **Checked:** more than 60 small businesses, a community hub, the 1912 terminus station, and the Diamond Creek Trail extended here in 2022 (Wikipedia). 86.1% Australia-born; India below 0.3%; 96.9% separate (ABS). **Estimate:** Nature 8, Village 8, Shops 5; among the most fire-exposed on the list; larger supermarkets at Diamond Creek (about 8 min). **Trade-off:** a true bush village on rail; remote, with the weakest Indian access.

## Added by Option C (coast-led)

**Seaford** · BAY · C · $861,235 (A) · GW 24 · ED 8 · train Y · 7.81 (#4) **Checked:** Kananook Creek Reserve is a 7.5 km corridor linking Seaford Wetlands to the Frankston foreshore (Frankston Council). 74.2% Australia-born; India not in the top responses (ABS). **Estimate:** Nature 7, Village 5, Beach 9; flat, easy walking; creek-corridor flood overlay possible. **Trade-off:** the cheapest credible bay-plus-creek suburb with a train, inside Mum's 25-minute limit; ordinary shops and almost no Indian community.

**Mount Martha** · PEN · C · $1,344,095 (A); Jellis Craig house median $1.40m · GW 47 · ED 19 (Rosebud) · train N · 5.87 (#30) **Checked:** the Jellis Craig median is $1.40m (6 Sep 2026), close to the cap (Jellis Craig); route 781 runs hourly (Transport Victoria); 76.4% Australia-born, 84.2% separate houses (ABS). **Estimate:** Nature 7 (Mount Martha Park, Balcombe Estuary), Beach 9, Shops 8; Frankston ED about 25 min; split-level bay-view homes. **Trade-off:** leafy bay living at the top of the budget, with an hourly bus.

**Dromana** · PEN · C · $906,318 (A); Jellis Craig house median $965,000 · GW 47 · ED 11! · train N · 5.98 (#29) **Checked:** Jellis Craig median $965,000 (6 Sep 2026) (Jellis Craig); route 781 ends here, hourly (Transport Victoria); 74.0% Australia-born, median age 50 (ABS). Rosebud Hospital ED is open 24 hours but treats moderate and minor cases; serious cases go to Frankston (Peninsula Health). **Estimate:** Nature 7 (Arthurs Seat State Park behind), Beach 9; major ED about 40 min away; hillside fire overlay; low foreshore inundation. **Trade-off:** beach and hills together; a long way from a major ED and a seasonal feel.

**Torquay** · GEE · C · $1,180,000 (S) · GW 88 · ED 23 · train N · 4.52 (#49) **Checked:** patrolled Front Beach, sheltered Cosy Corner and the Surf Coast Walk (Great Ocean Road); population 18,534, 82.8% Australia-born (ABS); bus 54 runs to Marshall Station (McHarrys). A 2026 projection gives $1.05M, but the source is low quality (Collings). **Estimate:** Beach 10, Nature 6, Village 7; summer congestion; the ED time is optimistic but plausible off-peak. **Trade-off:** the one true surf-beach option; 88 minutes is effectively over the limit once traffic bites.

### The other 30 passing suburbs in one line each

| Suburb (rank) | Note |
|---|---|
| Frankston (#1) | Top formula score and cheapest bayside sale median ($834,296); central Frankston has mixed amenity; Nature 6. Frankston South is the green counterpart. |
| Ferntree Gully (#3) | Flatter and busier than Upper Ferntree Gully (Nature 6, Shops 10); India-born 2.3% (632 people) (ABS). View as a pair with Upper Ferntree Gully. |
| Mentone (#6) | $1,497,099 is $3k under the cap (Woodards shows $1.30m); flat, Nature 5; no 24-hour public ED in the suburb. |
| Ringwood (#7) | Best logistics (12 min to family); mall and big-box feel, Nature 4; India-born 3.2% (618) (ABS). |
| Mordialloc (#10) | Strongest village feel of the bayside suburbs; AVM $1.40M, near the cap; India-born 1.4%. |
| Chelsea (#12) | Flat, few trees; the 19-minute ED time looks high; India-born 1.4%. |
| Altona (#13) | Flat coast, 35 min cross-city; new Footscray Hospital opened 18 Feb 2026 (Vic Health); Microburbs median $1.25M vs AVM $1.155M. |
| Heidelberg (#14) | Austin Hospital precinct; only 42.3% separate houses; $1.452M on 35 sales is near the cap. |
| Tecoma (#16) | Sherbrooke Forest adjoins; tiny highway strip; on the 2017 overlay list; a swap-in for Upwey. |
| Newport (#17) | Newport Lakes; industrial edges; Microburbs median $1.22M. |
| West Footscray (#18) | Nature 3; India-born 3.7% (SA2); industrial and truck traffic. |
| Rosanna (#19) | Hilly, leafy, split-level homes; 34 min; India-born 2.8% (245). |
| Rosebud (#25) | Open-mind pick; Beach 10, Nature 4; flat; ED is lower-acuity, Frankston 27 min per the workbook. |
| Montrose (#28) | Foothills township, no station (Mooroolbark 5.7 km); on the 2017 overlay list. |
| Drouin (#31) | Small town; ED is at Warragul; India-born 0.5% (postcode). |
| Emerald (#33) | Larger village with better odds of single-storey homes; 35 min; fire. |
| Healesville (#34) | A real town centre (Shops 9) but the hospital has no urgent care; residents report going to Maroondah, about 50 min, with 4 to 5 hour waits (Upper Yarra Mail). |
| McCrae (#35) | Small strip, hilly behind; median age 55; ED is Rosebud (minor cases); price median not found. |
| Newtown, Geelong (#37) | River sanctuary, Indian 7, ED about 7 min; 72 min to family; Jellis Craig median $1.08M. |
| Rye (#38) | Open-mind pick; 61 min; route 786 was removed on 5 Jul 2026; seasonal. |
| Olinda (#40) | Ridge village, no supermarket in the centre; fire and insurance; India-born 0.4%. |
| Gisborne (#41) | Best-serviced Macedon Ranges town (Shops 9) but modern estates (Nature 5); rail access unclear. |
| Mount Dandenong (#42) | Steep, narrow roads, few everyday services; only the SA2 census page was read. |
| Arthurs Seat (#43) | State Park forest (Nature 10) but no village, steep, and CFA fuel-reduction work at Pindara Rd in May 2026 (Mornington News); price rests on 5 sales. |
| Kyneton (#45) | Best heritage main street (Village 9); Bendigo Health ED is 54.6 km away (healthdirect); Jellis Craig median $840,000. |
| Yarra Glen (#46) | Vineyard flats, less forest (Nature 6); flood and fire both in play. |
| Riddells Creek (#47) | Small village, 71 min; median $1.01M on 30 sales, down 6.11% in the quarter. |
| Warburton (#48) | Top-tier nature (10) but 65 min to family, 53 min to ED, one main road; median age 50. |
| Macedon (#50) | Forest and Avenue of Honour; Shops 2; the 1983 Ash Wednesday fire destroyed 64 houses (Wikipedia); "limited afternoon services" by train (Wikipedia). |
| Wonthaggi (#51) | Bass Coast Health ED verified 24-hour (healthdirect); 88 min; median age 55; no rail. |

## Where the workbook and the research disagree

Items 1 to 9 can move a ranking or a hard filter; 10 to 18 are smaller. "Effect" says what I did in this report.

| # | Item | Workbook says | Research says | Effect and fix |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Highton price** | AVM $957,797 | PRD Q2 2026 house median $781,500 (241 sales) (PRD) | Kept workbook figure; about +0.09 score if swapped. Replace with a sale median. |
| 2 | **Healesville ED time** | 33 min | Local paper: no urgent care; residents go to Maroondah, about 50 min (Upper Yarra Mail). Same worry for Yarra Glen (30) and Warburton (53) | Kept 33, flagged "?". About −0.17 score at 50 min. Re-time the true ED route. |
| 3 | **Peninsula ED times** | 3 to 19 min for Dromana, Rye, McCrae, Rosebud, Mount Martha, Arthurs Seat | These measure the nearest ED (Rosebud, minor and moderate cases), not a major ED. Frankston is the major ED; the workbook gives Rosebud to Frankston as 27 min, other suburbs 30 to 45+ min (estimate) (Peninsula Health) | Marked "!". Moves the five tested suburbs 0 to 6 places; top 10 unchanged. Add a "major ED" column. |
| 4 | **Ferntree Gully and Upper FTG price** | Both $872,133 | OnTheHouse returns one postcode-level AVM; unit values differ ($678,759 vs unknown) | Marked ‡. Search each suburb's sold listings separately. |
| 5 | **Williamstown 3-bed evidence** | AVM $1,642,163, "needs data" | House median $1.58M (212 sales) (Property.com.au) or $1.49M (195 sales, down 5.4%) (Microburbs); 3-bed median $1.45M; 4-bed $1.92M. Sale dates not shown | Left out of ranking. About half of 3-bed sales are under the cap, but they cluster at the cheaper end; 3 adults each wanting a bedroom leaves no spare room. Check recent sold listings. |
| 6 | **Mum's 25-min Glen Waverley and 20-min ED answers vs the 90-min hard filter** | Hard filters 90 and 90 (Filters tab); Mum, Y: 25 and 20; Dad: 75 and no limit | **15 of 51** meet 25 and 20: Upper Ferntree Gully, Ferntree Gully, Upwey, Tecoma, Belgrave, The Basin, Montrose, Ringwood, Croydon, Heidelberg, Warrandyte, Mentone, Seaford, Frankston, Berwick. None on the Peninsula, in Macedon, Geelong or Gippsland | Family filter wins, as the workbook says. But ask Mum whether her numbers are limits or preferences (Round 2 follow-up). Option A has 5 suburbs inside them. |
| 7 | **Mum's 3 Essentials vs the cap of 2** | Cap is 2 per person (Settings) | Raw responses: Mum rated Nature, Near family and Indian community all "D". Dad and Y have two each (Nature, Near family) | Weights are computed as submitted. Round 2 enforces the cap; see scenarios below. |
| 8 | **Nature cut to 9% though all three rated it Essential** | Final Nature 9.0, Near GW 23.4 | The shift (7.2 points) was typed from earlier weights and the workbook says to recompute it after Round 2. The survey blueprint's own rule (loser weight minus winner weight plus 2 points, halved), applied to today's survey weights, moves only about 1.0 point (Q10 vote was 2 to 1 for Near family) | Shown as the "rule" column: Nature 15.2, Near GW 17.2, and Belgrave and Eltham return to the top 10. Decision for the family. |
| 9 | **Raw trade-off cells** | Q10 to Q12 cells hold criterion names | Q11 is recorded as "Village character", which matches neither option (flat suburb with beach, or hills with beach an hour away); Q13 is blank | Treat the Q10 to Q12 data as placeholders. Round 2 re-asks Q13 only. |
| 10 | **Saved file holds formulas without stored results** | Weights are formulas | Reading cached values gives blanks for CleanedAnswers, PriorityWeights and the final weights | I used the recalculated weights in the context note. Open and recalculate in Excel before relying on any total. |
| 11 | **Overseas-born figures** | Upper Ferntree Gully 19.2%; Frankston 22.5% | 100 minus Australia-born gives about 22.8% and 29%; ABS pages do not print the figure. A secondary site's Mentone figure (84.7% Australia-born) conflicts with the workbook (28.8% overseas-born); the workbook looks right | Not used in scores. Likely a "not stated" definition gap. |
| 12 | **Price vs independent medians** | AVMs and 3-bed medians | Woodend all-house $1.04M vs 3-bed $890k; Macedon $1.04M vs AVM $1,147,643; Newtown $1.08M vs $1,182,945; Mornington $1.20M vs $1,096,505; Altona $1.25M vs $1,155,073; Torquay about $1.05M (low-quality source) vs $1.18M; Wonthaggi $542,500 vs $587,666; Mentone Woodards $1.30m vs $1,497,099 | Marked †. Most gaps are under 20%; none changes cap status. |
| 13 | **Thin or odd price data** | Warburton 3-bed $717.5k, 4-bed $702.5k; Olinda and Sassafras unit AVMs above house AVMs; five suburbs under 40 sales | Thin sales (Macedon, Tecoma, Olinda, Sassafras, Mount Dandenong); units are 0 to 0.6% of stock in Olinda and Sassafras | Treat those prices as weak. |

| # | Item | Workbook says | Research says | Effect and fix |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 14 | **Train Yes/No** | Gisborne "Yes" (station in New Gisborne, about 3 km); Croydon "Yes" | Researchers found no Gisborne station on the Bendigo line (estimate); Wikipedia showed Croydon station closed from March 2024 for level-crossing works; Macedon and Riddells Creek have "limited afternoon services" | Kept workbook Y; all are recall-based. Check PTV and V/Line. |
| 15 | **Other ED times** | Frankston South 4; Chelsea 19; Kyneton 47; Woodend 55; Torquay 23 | Frankston South guess 8 to 12; Chelsea looks high; Kyneton to Bendigo is 54.6 km, marginal; Woodend plausible to Sunshine, optimistic to Bendigo; Torquay optimistic but plausible off-peak | Kept workbook values. Re-time. |
| 16 | **Heidelberg "borderline" on cost** | $1,452,000 under the $1.5M cap | One researcher called $1.54M with costs borderline. The cap applies to purchase price; the $1.59M ceiling includes the 6% allowance | No issue: $1.452M plus 6% is $1.539M. Thin sample (35 sales) is the real caution. |
| 17 | **Drive-time basis** | Google Maps "leave now", midday, 27 Oct (26 Oct for earlier rows) | Woodend read 77 min on 27 Oct vs 68 on the sheet, so recent readings run about 10% high; Torquay and Wonthaggi (88) sit within 2 min of the hard limit; Newtown's origin is approximate; Gisborne timed from the post office | Re-run the shortlist at peak and weekend times. |
| 18 | **Single-level need vs stairs allowed** | Stairs allowed (corrected 27 Oct); Mum's survey answer: "None at all" | Cards flag sloping and split-level stock in Eltham, Rosanna, Warrandyte, the Dandenong ridge and the Peninsula | Test Mum's view at the first viewings. |

## What is still unverified, and what to check next

### Unverified, in order of risk

| Gap | What is known | How to close it |
|---|---|---|
| **Hazard overlays** (bushfire, flood, coastal) | Not read at property level for any suburb. Only council-wide lists (the 2017 Yarra Ranges overlay list for Belgrave, Montrose, Mount Evelyn, Tecoma, Upper Ferntree Gully and Upwey), local history and news | Check each address on VicPlan (VicPlan), ask for a planning certificate, get an insurance quote before offering. |
| **Indian groceries, temples, gurdwaras** | **Checked for the six Community comparators** (named places and drive times in the comparator section; Endeavour Spices and Shri Sanatan Dharam still need verification). For the 51 scored suburbs, named in the notes: Sri Vakrathunda Vinayagar temple (The Basin); Shiva Vishnu Temple (Carrum Downs) and Keysborough Gurdwara (Faith Victoria); a temple association in Geelong (address not found). Named grocers: **not found** for any suburb. India-born share exact only where India is in the census top five | Build a short list of named shops and temples; time the drive from each shortlisted suburb. |
| **Drive times at one consistent time** | Midday "leave now" only for the 51; the comparators are checked at 08:00 and 10:00 weekday, so the two sets differ in basis | Re-time the 12 on a weekday 8am, Saturday 10am and Sunday 5pm, to Glen Waverley and to the ED. |
| **Sale medians vs AVMs** | 38 of 51 prices are AVMs | Pull sold listings for 3+ bedroom houses in each shortlisted suburb. |
| **Train Yes/No and frequency** | From recall; V/Line frequency only system-wide | Check PTV and V/Line timetables; ask about Croydon and Gisborne stations. |
| **ED status and waits** | Read and confirmed 24-hour: Wonthaggi, Rosebud, Frankston, Footscray. Angliss and West Gippsland are marked verified in the workbook (Eastern Health site, shire directory) but the Angliss notes are mixed. Casey, Northern, Sunshine, Maroondah, Bendigo and Ballarat are from recall | Confirm and check typical waits. |
| **Everyday services** | Supermarket, GP and pharmacy names mostly unverified; bus frequencies not read | Measure the real drive to the nearest supermarket and GP. |

| Gap | What is known | How to close it |
|---|---|---|
| **Scores themselves** | One researcher's judgement per suburb; Nature and Village are least verified | Each family member scores the 12 after viewing. |

## At inspection

| Check | Why | Most relevant to |
|---|---|---|
| Overlay map and fire-season exit road, driven once | Single access roads and steep, narrow ridge roads | Warrandyte, Warburton, Sassafras, Olinda, Arthurs Seat, Hurstbridge |
| Stairs, slope and driveway, with Mum present | Her single-level answer is unresolved | Eltham, Rosanna, Warrandyte, ridge suburbs, Frankston South, Mount Martha |
| A winter-style drive (ice, fog, fallen trees) | Ridge and Macedon winters | Macedon Ranges, Dandenong ridge |
| Three bedrooms or a self-contained space | Three adults; Mum and Y chose "living together", Y a granny flat or separate unit | All; Williamstown-type 3-bed stock is tight |
| Garden upkeep | Dad's Q2 answer is "looking after the house and land" | Large bush blocks |
| Real walk to shops, GP and station | Parents expect to drive 10+ years, but not forever | Dandenong ridge villages, Macedon |
| Noise, flood and industry on the street | Flat coast and west suburbs | Altona, Newport, West Footscray, Chelsea |
| ED route and a test run | Peninsula and Macedon distances | Dromana, Rye, Woodend, Kyneton |

## What Round 2 (Q13 and Q15) will settle

The comparator viewings make Q13 concrete: Endeavour Hills and Wheelers Hill test whether "both" is possible; Springvale, Clayton South, Keysborough and Clyde North show option A at full strength. Round 4 adds **Q13d** (5-point scale: green village with community about 30 min away, or a multicultural neighbourhood with community close by). Q13d is reference-only: it feeds no weight and is not yet in the workbook.

Q13 asks: "Indian shops and community in your own suburb, less green" (A) or "very green, community a 30-minute drive away" (B). Q15 re-asks all ten priority ratings with a cap of two Essentials. I recalculated the top 10 under each possible answer using the workbook's current shifts (so these are **illustrative**).

| Answer | What changes in the weights | Effect on ranking |
|---|---|---|
| **Q13 = A** (Indian community wins) | Little: Indian (10.7) already outweighs Nature (9.0), so the documented rule moves about 0.15 points | No change. Berwick (Indian 9), Newtown and Highton (7), Ringwood, Heidelberg, West Footscray (6) stay where they are. |
| **Q13 = B** (very green wins) | About 1.85 points move from Indian to Nature (Nature 11.8%, Indian 9.7% after rescaling) | Belgrave enters the top 10, Ringwood leaves. Berwick slips to 3rd. |
| **Q15: Mum drops Indian community to Important** | Indian falls from 11.7% to 9.1%; Nature 10.3% | Belgrave enters, Croydon leaves; Berwick falls from 2nd to 3rd. |
| **Q15: Mum drops Near family to Important** | Near family 25.5% to 23.0%; Indian 12.2% | Top 10 unchanged; small gains for far-out suburbs. |
| **Q15: Mum drops Nature to Important** | Nature falls to 7.3% | Top 10 unchanged but Ringwood climbs to 5th; the viewing list should then lean to A or C. |
| **Q15: Nature kept at 16% or higher (all three Essential, shift cut)** | Nature 17.7% | Belgrave 5th, Eltham 8th; at 30%, Belgrave 1st, Upper Ferntree Gully 2nd. Option B becomes the main list. |
| **Q15: Indian community set to zero** | Berwick drops from 2nd to 11th; Seaford, Upwey, Belgrave rise | Berwick moves from control to a calibration-only visit. |

Two questions Round 2 does not cover but the ranking depends on: whether **Mum's 25-minute and 20-minute limits** are hard (only 15 suburbs survive), and whether the **90-minute filter** should drop to the 60-minute preference (11 suburbs go: Warburton, Rye, Kyneton, Woodend, Macedon, Gisborne, Riddells Creek, Newtown, Highton, Torquay, Wonthaggi). Y's beach preference also bears on the Beach weight, which every scenario above holds at 8.8%.

## Conclusion

**Update, 28 Oct.** The family now has a fair test of the community side. Six comparators that meet every hard filter on checked evidence sit beside the nature-first anchors (Frankston, Mordialloc, Seaford, all Low on community). Endeavour Hills is the one suburb found so far that scores on both sides (bush reserve walkable, Indian grocer, temple and church within about 15 min), so it is in all three options. If the family comes back from Springvale or Clyde North preferring them, the Indian-community weight is understated; if they come back preferring Belgrave or Eltham, the 27 Oct finding below stands. The paragraphs below are unchanged from 27 Oct; their ranks predate the workbook's entered scores (see the update box at the top).

The research does not name a winner; it shows that **the answer turns on one number the family has not yet agreed: how much Nature weighs.** At 9% the formula rewards Frankston, Berwick and the two Ferntree Gullys. At 30% it puts Belgrave and Upper Ferntree Gully first and brings Eltham and Tecoma into the top eight. Frankston South, Eltham, Warragul, Croydon and Berwick sit on every shortlist, so those viewings are worth doing whichever way Round 2 lands. Berwick is in the top two under every weight set tested and Croydon between 9th and 12th, so seeing them is the quickest test of whether the family's love of forest survives contact with convenience.

The second finding is a tension nobody has named: **Mum's own limits (25 and 20 minutes) cover only 15 suburbs, all in the east and south-east**, while the family's 90-minute filter admits the coast, Macedon, Geelong and Gippsland that Dad and Y ask for. Whether her numbers are firm decides whether Options B and C are real choices. The third is practical: with 38 of 51 prices as automated estimates and no property-level hazard checks, the first viewings should also collect sold prices, overlay maps and an insurance quote, not only impressions.

## Sources

Sources are the researchers' notes (Dandenong foothills, ridge and Yarra Valley, north-east, Mornington Peninsula, bayside and south-east, Macedon and Geelong, west and Gippsland) and the workbook. Main sources are linked in the cards. Others used:

| Topic | Source |
|---|---|
| Census 2021 QuickStats | ABS, one page per suburb; links in the cards and below |
| ABS Ringwood | https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL22174 |
| ABS Heidelberg, Rosanna | https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL21167, https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL22194 |
| ABS Chelsea, Mordialloc, Frankston | https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL20537, https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL21760, https://abs.gov.au/census/find-census-data/quickstats/2021/SAL20947 |
| Local ED and hospital | Peninsula Health, healthdirect, Vic Health (linked above) |
| Prices | Jellis Craig suburb reports, PRD, Microburbs, Property.com.au, Domain, Collings (linked above) |
| Bush and flood history | Wikipedia pages for each suburb; Star Mail; Manningham Council; VICSES; Mornington News |
| Drive times and the family's rules | Workbook, Filters and SuburbScorecard tabs (Google Maps "leave now" readings, 26 and 27 Oct 2026) |
| Community comparators | `Community comparators — research (28 Oct 2026).md`: Google Maps directions and place listings (28 Oct 2026), Victorian Statements of Information, Jellis Craig Wheelers Hill report (Sep 2026), healthdirect, Victorian Department of Health, Mercy Health, ABS 2021 General Community Profile; workbook SuburbScorecard rows 67–72 and DiscussionSummary A31:B38 |